PRODUCT THINKING CASE STUDY

Reducing Investment Decision Overload

Helping retail investors confidently decide where — and how much — to invest across equity, mutual funds, REITs, bonds, and gold.

MONIKA M

THE PROBLEM

Choice overload is stalling retail investors

Retail investors struggle to **translate their goals and risk appetite into a concrete allocation** when **faced with dozens of overlapping products and unfamiliar metrics across platforms**, which results in **decision paralysis, under-diversified portfolios, and delayed wealth creation.**

1 The abandoned first portfolio

A first-time investor opens a platform with a ₹2 lakh surplus, scrolls past 4,000+ mutual funds and a dozen unfamiliar ratios, and closes the app without investing a rupee.

2 The accidental over-concentration

An investor with a 10-year horizon ends up 90% in fixed deposits — not by choice, but because equity volatility metrics like Sharpe ratio and beta felt too risky to interpret.

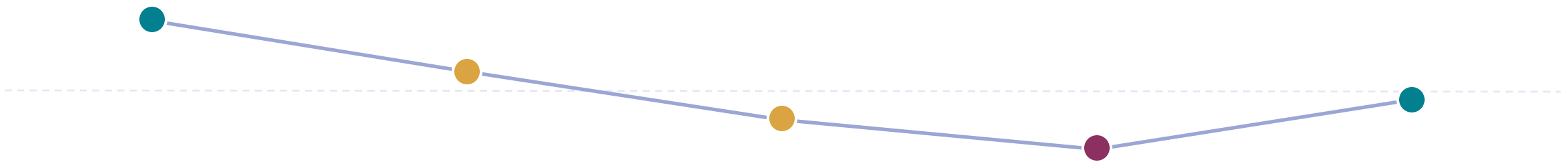
3% vs 30%

In the landmark Iyengar & Lepper choice-overload study, shoppers offered 24 options purchased at just a 3% rate — versus 30% when offered only 6. The same overload plays out when an investing app surfaces every product instead of a guided few.

STEP 1 · FIRSTHAND RESEARCH

User journey: a first-time investor's ₹1–5L portfolio build

Investor confidence



1

Discover platform

0–2 min

Optimistic

“Excited to finally start investing.”

2

Browse options

2–8 min

Overwhelmed

“4,000+ mutual funds — where do I even start?”

3

Compare metrics

8–15 min

Confused

“What's CAGR vs. XIRR vs. Sharpe ratio?”

4

Hesitate & re-check

15–20 min

Anxious

“What if I pick wrong and lose money?”

5

Decision point

20–25 min

Split outcome

60% abandon the session · 40% put money in one familiar fund

FRAMEWORK #1

Jobs to Be Done: what are investors really hiring a platform to do?

FIRST-TIME INVESTOR

When I have surplus savings sitting idle, I want to start investing without mastering every asset class first, so I can grow my money without fear of a costly mistake.

GOAL-BASED SAVER

When I'm saving for a goal 10+ years away, I want a portfolio that reflects my time horizon and risk appetite automatically, so I'm not re-deciding every time markets move.

TAX-CONSCIOUS INVESTOR

When the fiscal year-end approaches, I want to find tax-saving instruments that still fit my broader portfolio, so I don't make a rushed, disconnected decision.

Beneath every statement: three layers of the job

Functional

Allocate surplus cash into a mix that matches goal + horizon, correctly.

Emotional

Feel confident and in control, not anxious about an irreversible mistake.

Social

Be seen — by family, self — as a responsible, informed money manager.

KEY INSIGHTS

- The job is rarely “pick an asset” — it's “feel confident I won't regret this.”
- Different life moments call for different depth of guidance, not one generic flow.
- Emotional and social jobs (confidence, responsibility) matter as much as the math.

FRAMEWORK #2

Opportunity Solution Tree: from goal to concrete solutions

GOAL: Help investors confidently decide where & how much to invest

OPPORTUNITY

Investors can't translate risk appetite into an allocation

- Guided 5-question risk & goal quiz that outputs a suggested split
- Model portfolios by life stage, ready to customize

OPPORTUNITY

Comparing asset classes means decoding unfamiliar metrics

- Plain-language cards translating CAGR, Sharpe & expense ratio
- “3 things that matter” summary per asset class

OPPORTUNITY

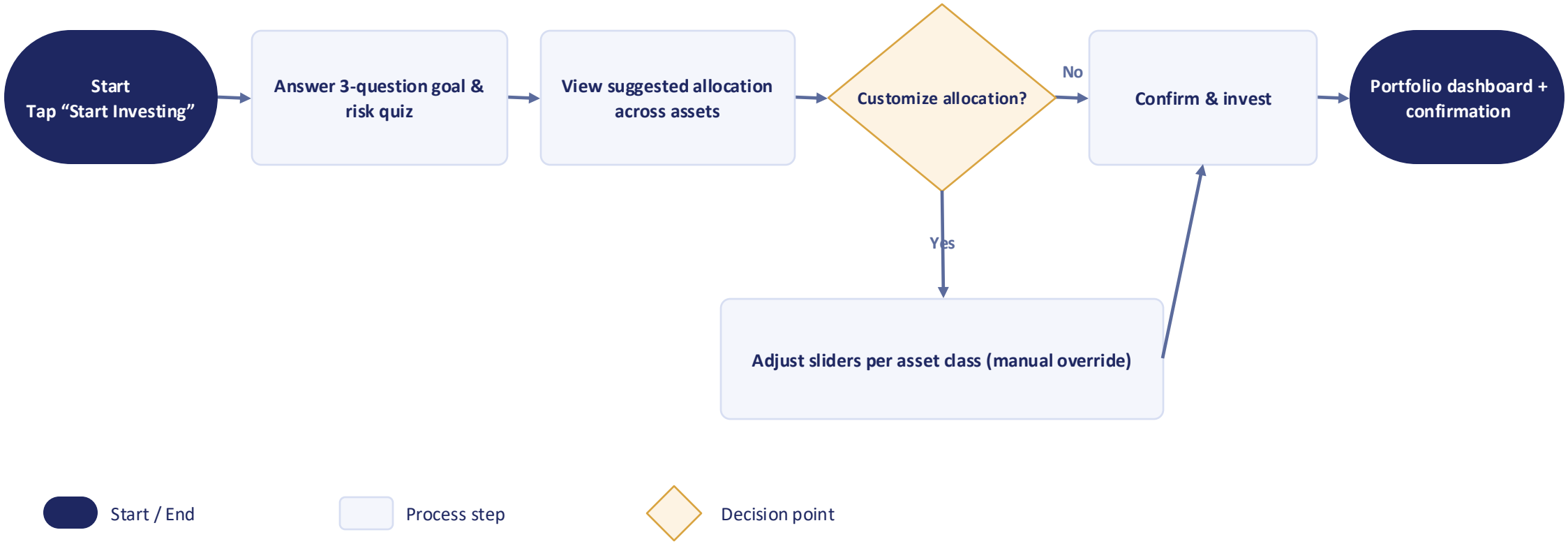
Investors over-concentrate in familiar assets

- Diversification nudge: current vs. recommended allocation gap
- “Try a small amount first” micro-investment prompts

Key insight: Nearly every opportunity resolves with a guided default plus room to customize — investors want a starting point, not a blank canvas.

PROPOSED SOLUTION

User flow: guided allocation, start to invested



Design principle: every path — default or customized — converges on the same confident “Confirm & invest” moment.

FROM INSIGHTS TO SOLUTION

Four product moves that resolve the overload

1 Guided Allocation Engine

A 3–question goal & risk quiz outputs a suggested split by asset class — a starting point, not a blank canvas.

2 Plain-Language Comparisons

CAGR, XIRR, Sharpe ratio and expense ratio translated into “what this means for you,” not raw jargon.

3 Diversification Nudges

A simple visual gap between current and recommended allocation flags over-concentration before it compounds.

4 Confidence-First Confirmation

One clear summary screen before investing — no scattered metrics, no second-guessing at the last step.

Together, these turn “which of 4,000 options is right?” into “here's a plan — adjust as you like.”

KEY TAKEAWAYS

Guided beats exhaustive

Confidence is the real product

Investors aren't short on options — they're short on certainty that a choice is right for them.

Default + customize wins

Every framework and flow converged on the same pattern: a sensible starting allocation, with room to adjust.

Simplify the vocabulary, not the choice

Translating metrics into plain language removes friction without removing investor control.

Thank you